

1. Who I am and my target role

- Name: Cameron Phillips
- Program: Cybersecurity & Networking
- Target NICE work role: Systems Administrator
- Why this role: Each simulation I chose maps to a core sysadmin duty: supporting users, deploying infrastructure, and protecting it.

2. Practicum work

Simulation	What I did	Skills and tools	NICE role
Service Desk	Acted as a first-line agent: triaged tickets, worked a network outage and escalated it to the correct team.	Ticketing system, knowledge base, ITIL escalation, prioritising by impact and urgency, customer updates, documentation	Technical Support Specialist
Introduction to Cloud	Helped WCD Bank (fictional) move to the cloud by registering an application and enabling a function; built a repository with an automated workflow.	Git, GitHub repository, GitHub Actions, command line, attention to detail	Systems Administrator
Cyber Security Operations	Investigated a simulated data breach, wrote a report, then completed a prioritised risk assessment.	Breach impact analysis, identifying exploited weaknesses, ranking assets, threats and likelihood, report writing	Cyber Defense Incident Responder

Time spent: 4 hours

3. Top findings

- Service Desk: The main risk was not technical skill but confusion over what to handle first, who to pass it to, and what to tell the client. Without clear rules, serious outages can sit in the queue beside routine requests.
- Introduction to Cloud: Making proper cloud infrastructure.
- Cyber Security Operations: The proper manner of handling a security incident.

4. Recommendations and the decision needed

Recommendations from the Service Desk simulation:

#	Recommendation	Effort	Owner	Trade-off
1	Set written rules for ranking tickets by impact and urgency, so an outage always outranks routine requests.	Low	Service desk lead	Staff have less room for judgment.
2	Define when and how to escalate, with named contacts and time limits.	Low to medium	Service delivery manager	Some unneeded escalations cost specialists time.
3	Use ready-made update templates sent to clients at set intervals during an outage.	Medium	Service desk lead with communications	Frequent updates take time from fixing the problem.

Decision for leadership: approve a pilot of these three changes to outage handling. It needs about two weeks of staff time and no new spending, and the service desk lead would report back after one month.

5. What I learned and what is next

- Honesty: Reporting what the evidence supports, without softening or exaggerating risk (ISC2 Code of Ethics, Canon 2).
- Staying in scope: Escalating what is beyond my tier and access is the competent choice, not a failure (ISC2 Code of Ethics, Canon 3).
- Next steps: CCNA certification